# PEDIGREES

Pedigrees or family trees show how a particular characteristic is passed down through several generations of a family.

In determining whether a particular characteristic is ***dominant*** or ***recessive***, look at the ***parents and their offspring at any part*** of the pedigree.

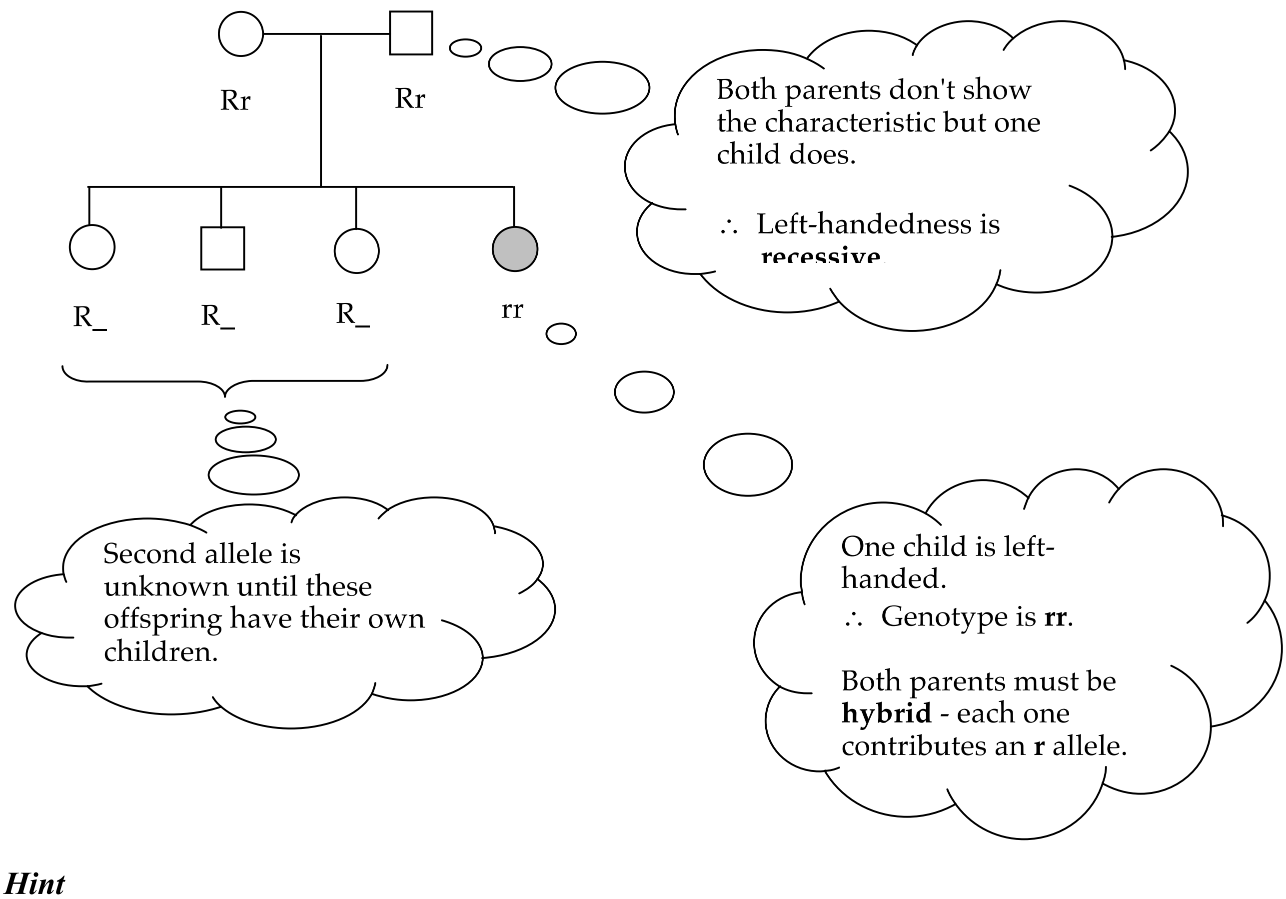
> If both parents ***DON'T SHOW*** the characteristic, and at least one offspring ***DOES***, then the characteristic is ***RECESSIVE***.
>
> If both parents ***DO SHOW*** the characteristic, and at least one offspring ***DOESN'T***, then the characteristic is ***DOMINANT***.

**Example**

Consider the incidence of ***left-handedness*** in a family.

□ Male (normal) ■ Male (with characteristic)

○ Female (normal) ● Female (with characteristic)




***Hint***

Always ***start at the bottom of a pedigree*** and work your way upward when determining the genotypes of all the individuals.